

DATA GOVERNANCE MATURITY & ROI EXECUTIVE REPORT

Platform: **ALATION** | Scope: Enterprise Implementation | Evaluation Date: 2026-06-05

Executive Summary: An automated maturity assessment was conducted on **50** data assets managed by Alation. The implementation achieves a **Governance Health Index (GHI) of 50.03%**, reflecting moderate governance execution. Financially, the program has generated **\$24,066,816.46** in realized business value (productivity savings, incident avoidance, and compliance risk mitigation) against an estimated annual cost of **\$120,000.00**. This yields an outstanding net realized value of **\$23,946,816.46**. Additionally, the engine has identified **\$12,688,896.48** in unrealized, actionable opportunity savings that can be unlocked through targeted remediation efforts (such as decommissioning ROT storage and securing un-owned PII).

1. Governance Implementation Maturity Breakdown

Maturity is assessed across four key pillars mapped from raw vendor metadata:

Pillar Parameter	Weight	Score	Status
Documentation Completeness	30%	73.40%	Adequate
Data Quality Coverage	40%	49.75%	Action Needed
Lineage Transparency	20%	6.00%	Action Needed
Security & Policy Risk	10%	30.90%	Moderate Risk
Governance Health Index	100%	50.03%	Active

2. Program Financial Performance & ROI Analysis

The value realized through metadata-driven automation and risk mitigation compared to software licensing and overhead operating costs:

Financial Metric Category	Amount (\$)	Value Explanation
Annual Operating Cost	\$120,000.00	Fixed software licensing and support overhead cost.
Realized Discovery Savings	\$23,039,383.50	Productivity savings from faster data discovery.
Realized DQ Incident Avoidance	\$810,000.00	Savings from avoiding pipeline failures and business downtime.
Realized Risk Avoidance	\$179,400.00	Mitigated risk of security breaches and regulatory non-compliance.
Realized Compute Optimization	\$38,032.96	Warehouse credit waste avoided via data quality monitoring.
Net Realized Program Value	\$23,946,816.46	Net financial return of the program.
Return on Investment (ROI)	19955.68%	Program efficiency ratio.
Unrealized Opportunity Value	\$12,688,896.48	Value pipeline achievable through remediation tasks.

3. Executive Action Plan & Remediation Pipeline

The engine has identified key prioritized actions to reduce costs and secure sensitive corporate data:

Category	Asset Name	Risk / Telemetry Details	Recommended Action	Value Impact
Storage / ROT	executive_kpi_125	Size: 136.0 GB (578d stale)	Decommission or archive storage	Saves \$6.53/yr
Storage / ROT	user_retention_129	Size: 219.2 GB (373d stale)	Decommission or archive storage	Saves \$2.60/yr
Storage / ROT	temp_customer_export_2024	Size: 120.0 GB (190d stale)	Decommission or archive storage	Saves \$1.43/yr
Compliance / PII	temp_customer_export_2024	Risk: 80.0/100 Queries: 3/mo	Assign Steward & classification tags	Mitigates \$120,000.00 risk
Compliance / PII	marketing_attribution_123	Risk: 80.0/100 Queries: 8/mo	Assign Steward & classification tags	Mitigates \$120,000.00 risk
Compliance / PII	backup_restore.tar.gz_109	Risk: 75.0/100 Queries: 1833/mo	Assign Steward & classification tags	Mitigates \$112,500.00 risk
Trust / Low DQ	marketing_attribution_123	DQ Pass Rate: 0.0% Queries: 8/mo	Implement validation rules in pipeline	Avoids debug costs
Trust / Low DQ	temp_customer_export_2024	DQ Pass Rate: 0.0% Queries: 3/mo	Implement validation rules in pipeline	Avoids debug costs
Trust / Low DQ	orders_138	DQ Pass Rate: 0.0% Queries: 1528/mo	Implement validation rules in pipeline	Avoids debug costs

APPENDIX: ROI METHODOLOGY & ASSUMPTIONS

To ensure auditability, the calculations in this executive assessment are based on the following models and parameter mappings. These baselines are grounded in industry studies conducted by Gartner, Forrester, IBM Security, and standard cloud platform metrics.

Model Baseline Constants & Citation Sources

Parameter Constants	Value	Research Context / Citation Source
Loaded Analyst Rate	\$75.00/hr	U.S. Labor Bureau senior loaded rate averages (1.35x multiplier).
Hours Saved per Search	3.5 hrs	Forrester TEI data catalog productivity metrics.
Annual Storage Cost / GB	\$0.24	Standard hot cloud object tier blended averages (AWS, Azure).
Data Quality Error Cost	\$15,000.00	Gartner & Monte Carlo operational cost studies.
Compliance Breach Penalty	\$150,000.00	IBM Cost of Data Breach localized/tier-1 infraction fine.

Equations & Derivations

- Productivity Savings:** (Annual Queries * 10% search ratio) * 3.5 hrs saved * Analyst loaded rate * (Doc Score / 100). Grounded in Forrester's TEI frameworks.
- ROT Decommissioning:** Identified as size > 0, queries < 5/mo, and last accessed > 180 days. Savings = GB Size * \$0.24/yr. Grounded in AWS/Azure storage tiers.
- DQ Incident Avoidance:** (Unmonitored baseline [4.0] - Current incidents) * \$15k cost. Active DQ profiling drops current errors to 2.0 (for DQ >= 80%) or 0.0 (for DQ >= 95%). Grounded in Gartner data quality impact surveys.
- Risk Avoidance:** (Baseline breach prob. [5.0%] - Current prob.) * \$150k breach penalty. Controls (ownership and classification) reduce probability to 1.0% (0.2% with active DQ checks). Grounded in IBM Security breach statistics and DAMA DMBOK principles.
- Compute Optimization:** Snowflake credit waste avoided on bad/unoptimized queries, calculated based on the active warehouse sizes, average credit rates (\$3.00/credit), and active DQ monitoring rules.
- Net Program Value:** Net Value = Total Realized Savings - Annual Operating Cost.
- Return on Investment (ROI) %:** ROI % = (Net Realized Program Value / Annual Operating Cost) * 100.
- Unrealized Opportunity Value:** Sum of remaining discovery opportunity + DQ opportunity + Risk mitigation + ROT storage decommissioning savings.

Governance Implementation Maturity Formulas

- Documentation Completeness Score:** Base score of 40 for presence of description, +10 points if description length > 50 characters, +30 points if asset has designated owners, and +20 points if glossary terms are mapped (Max: 100).
- Data Quality Coverage Score:** Data quality rule pass rate scaled to 0-100% (0.0% if no rules are configured).
- Lineage Transparency Score:** 50 points if upstream lineage links exist, and 50 points if downstream lineage links exist (Max: 100).
- Security & Policy Risk Score:** 20 points if asset is sensitive, +40 points if sensitive and has no designated owners, +20 points if untagged, and +20 points if it has 0 data quality rules configured (Max: 100, where higher is more risky).
- Governance Health Index (GHI):** Weighted index = (Documentation Completeness * 0.3) + (Data Quality Coverage * 0.4) + (Lineage Transparency * 0.2) + ((100 - Security & Policy Risk) * 0.1).